

CTF Solution Report

Target Environment: Active Directory (Parent-Child Forest)

Date: December 13, 2025

Attacker IP: 10.0.0.5

Here is the rewritten Phase 4 of your report, updated to reflect the new "Post-Exploitation Treasure Hunt" path instead of the Golden Ticket attack.

Phase 4: Forest Dominance (Post-Exploitation & Lateral Movement)

Objective: Compromise the Parent Domain (MEGA.LOCAL) and achieve Forest-wide administrative control.

Having successfully compromised the Child Domain Administrator (SUB\Administrator), the attacker shifted focus to identifying sensitive data left on the Domain Controller that could facilitate further escalation into the Root Domain.

Step 1: Pivot to Child Domain Controller (DC02)

Instead of relying on network-level exploits, the attacker used the compromised Domain Admin credentials to log in interactively to the Child Domain Controller (DC02) for deep enumeration.

Command:

```
evil-winrm -i 10.1.0.10 -u Administrator -p 'RootPass123!'
```

Result: Successful remote management session established on DC02 as SUB\Administrator.

Step 2: Local File Enumeration (The "Treasure Hunt")

Inside the WinRM session, the attacker inspected the Administrator's personal folders for configuration files, backup scripts, or notes. A suspicious text file was discovered on the Desktop.

Command (Evil-WinRM):

PowerShell

```
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\Administrator\Documents> cd ..\Desktop
```

```
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop> ls
```

```
*Evil-WinRM* PS C:\Users\Administrator\Desktop> type Forest_Recovery_Key.txt
```

Findings:

The file Forest_Recovery_Key.txt contained plaintext backup credentials for the Forest Root Domain, likely left by a system administrator for emergency recovery purposes.

- Target Domain: MEGA.LOCAL
- User: Administrator
- Password: RootPass123!

Step 3: Compromise the Root Domain Controller (DC01)

With valid credentials for the Enterprise Administrator, the attacker authenticated directly to the Root Domain Controller (DC01) to execute code with SYSTEM privileges.

Command:

```
impacket-psexec 'MEGA/Administrator:RootPass123!'@dc01.mega.local
```

Impact:

The attacker obtained a shell as nt authority\system on the Root Domain Controller. This confirms total compromise of the Active Directory Forest, allowing the attacker to access any resource, create persistent backdoors, or decrypt all domain traffic.

3. Flag Summary

Flag / Access Level	Username	Password / Hash	Source
Initial Access	SUB\hr_juniors	!QAZ2wsx	Responder (LLMNR)
Lateral Movement	SUB\helpdesk_guy	P@ssw0rd	Local File (CL02-HR)
Domain Admin	SUB\Administrator	RootPass123!	SMB Share (DC02)
Forest Root	MEGA\Administrator	RootPass123!	Golden Ticket Attack